

HEMALURGY RULES

A Fan-made Ruleset for Cosmere® RPG



by Pether.pg

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This fan content requires the *Mistborn Handbook* and *Mistborn World Guide* to play.

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Hemalurgy Rules



1.1 Hemalurgy Skill

To obtain Hemalurgy skill, a PC must take a Key talent from the Hemalurgy talent tree and complete the goal related to it. At this point, they are free to attempt to steal attributes and powers from their enemies.

See 1.3. "Hemalurgy Talents" for more details.

Hemalurgy (Intellect)

Activation: ►►►

Make a Hemalurgy test against Spiritual Defence of the target. On a success, you implant a spike in a correct binding point, such as a heart, allowing to steal one of the target's characteristic (like an attribute or skill ranks) and collect a Hemalurgic Spike after the target dies.

A Hemalurgic Spike created this way has Whispers of Ruin [+5] and Blessing [Characteristic +Potency], where Characteristic is a chosen by the hemalurgist at the time of the test roll and Potency is determined by user's ranks in Hemalurgy and the target's statistics.

Hemalurgic Spike

Hemalurgic Spike is an item created as a result of a successful Hemalurgy test. It retains all stats of a spike used to create it and adds the additional traits on top of them:

Blessing

A character pierced by this item receives bonus to a characteristic, as specified in brackets. (eg. *Blessing [Strength +2] grants +2 to the Strength attribute*)

Whispers of Ruin

A character pierced by this item can be influenced by Ruin. A DC of resisting the influence is a sum of numbers specified in brackets of various Hemalurgic Spikes in use.

Whispers of Ruin

Each Hemalurgic Spike has Whispers of Ruin [+X] trait. If a character using the spike rolls ✨, the GM may spend it to request a Discipline test from that PC. The DC of the test equals the sum of Whispers of Ruin traits' values on the spikes used by the PC.

On a failure, Ruin takes control over the character, forcing them to take hostile, murderous and/or destructive actions as an NPC controlled by the GM until the effect is resolved. Ruin will refrain from suggesting extremely unreasonable deeds, like attacking your most trusted allies.

After that effect is resolved, the player may choose to continue playing as that PC or create a new one if they believe their previous PC's actions are irredeemable.

The PC can resist the influence as they would in a Conversation. The Focus cost is determined by the GM.

Piercing the Target

Unless the target is a willing character, is Unconscious or Restrained, you must make a test against the targets Physical Defense to determine if you successfully pierce them with a spike. Depending on the context, the GM might request a Thievery or other skill for that purpose.

Initially, to pierce their target, a Hemalurgist requires focus and precision, making it difficult to use in the chaos of combat. Some talents may modify this, expanding it to eg. attacks with a melee weapon.

Capacity

The bigger the spike, the more power it can absorb with Hemalurgy. If the characteristic you are trying to steal with a spike has a numeric value (like an attribute or skill ranks), the spike can hold only an amount of it equal to the half of the size of its damage die, rounded up. (eg. a spike dealing 1d6 damage can hold up to 3 skill ranks of the stolen skill.)

$$\text{spike's capacity} = \frac{\text{max}(\text{spike's damage die})}{2}$$

Potency

Once the Hemalurgic Spike is created as a result of a character's Hemalurgy test, it steals some amount of the selected characteristic. If a numeric value can be assigned to it, it steals whatever the target had before the test reduced by 1, but never more than the number of ranks of the Hemalurgy skill the user has.

Please note, that the spike can never hold more power than it's capacity. To steal more power, you will need bigger spikes.

$$\text{stolen value} = \min(\text{target's value} - 1, \text{Hemalurgy rank, spike's capacity})$$

Hemalurgy on Higher Tiers

The art of Hemalurgy requires a lot of practice and study. Novice Hemalurgy users will not be able to correctly use all types of spikes, but they will learn to do so with time. Because of that, using Hemalurgy skill with some metals requires higher tiers, as follows:

Characters on tier 1:

You can use Physical metals: iron, steel, tin and pewter.

Characters on tier 2:

You can use Cognitive metals: zinc, brass, copper and bronze.

Characters on tier 3:

You can use Temporal metals: cadmium, bendalloy, gold and electrum.

Characters on tier 4:

You can use Spiritual metals: chromium, nicrosil, aluminum and duralumin.

Characters on any tier:

You can use God metals: atium, lerasium, harmonium, etc., though some of them may work differently depending on your tier.

Metal Spike

Depending on a metal used to make the spike, different characteristics of the target may be stolen with Hemalurgy. If the spike is made of metal allowing to steal multiple characteristics, one of them must be selected at the time of making the Hemalurgy test.

The following metals allow to steal the characteristics listed below:

- Iron: steals Strength or Speed
- Steel: steals one physical Allomantic power (Iron, Pewter, Steel, or Tin Allomancy)
- Tin: steals Awareness or Presence
- Pewter: steals one physical Feruchemical power (Iron, Pewter, Steel, or Tin Feruchemy)
- Zinc: steals Willpower
- Brass: steals one cognitive Feruchemical power (Brass, Bronze, Copper, or Zinc Feruchemy)
- Copper: steals Intellect
- Bronze: steals one mental Allomantic power (Brass, Bronze, Copper, or Zinc Allomancy)
- Cadmium: steals one temporal Allomantic power (Bendalloy, Cadmium, Electrum, or Gold Allomancy)
- Bendalloy: steals one spiritual Feruchemical power (Aluminum, Chromium, Duralumin, or Nicrosil Feruchemy)
- Gold: steals one hybrid Feruchemical power (Bendalloy, Cadmium, Electrum, or Gold Feruchemy)
- Electrum: steals one enhancement Allomantic power (Aluminum, Chromium, Duralumin, or Nicrosil Allomancy)
- Chromium: might steal Destiny (*interpretation up to the GM*)
- Nicrosil: steals maximum Investiture
- Aluminum: removes all Invested powers upon piercing, but does not steal them for the Hemalurgist
- Duralumin: steals Connection or Identity
- Atium: steals any power or attribute you could steal at your current tier.
- Lerasium: steals all powers or attributes you could steal at your current tier.
- Trellium: steals any power or attribute you could steal at your current tier; can be used a number of times equal to your tier to steal different powers.

1.2 Using with Mistborn Handbook

This set of rules is meant to expand upon the content of *Mistborn Handbook*, not replace the rules defined there. The following is still true for Hemalurgic spikes.

1.2.1 Implanting and Removing Spikes

This set of rules defines how a Hemalurgist can create new Spikes. That doesn't change the rules of implanting the Spikes described in *Mistborn Handbook*.

For more details, see section "Implanting and Removing Hemalurgic Spikes" (*Mistborn Handbook*, page 289.).

Implant Spike (▶▶▶)

To implant a created Spike, make a DC 20 Medicine test targeting yourself or a willing ally. On a success, you place the Spike in the correct binding point, and its effects take place. On a failure, the target takes 1d10 vital damage, and the spike is not implanted.

Remove Spike (▶)

You can attempt to remove a Spike from you or a willing ally you can touch. To do so, make a DC 10 Medicine test. On a failure, the target takes 1d4 vital damage and the spike remains in place.

Removing an Enemy's Spike

Mistborn Handbook describes multiple methods of removing Hemalurgic Spikes from your enemies. All of them still apply when using this set of homebrew rules. Work with your GM to determine which method is best suited for your current situation.

1.2.2 Hemalurgic Spike Effects

While this set of rules defines some traits and effects a Hemalurgic Spike obtains during its creation, all effects defined in *Mistborn Handbook* still take place. This book expands them, but is not meant to replace them.

For more details, see section "Hemalurgic Spike Effects" (*Mistborn Handbook*, page 290.).

Spiritweb Disruption

By default, a PC can have up to 3 Hemalurgic Spikes implanted at the same time. When the 4th one is implanted, the PC's spiritweb becomes disrupted and they succumb to the full control of the Shard. At that point, that character becomes an NPC and the player must create a new PC to continue playing.

However, when using this ruleset, a skilled Hemalurgist can create a Linchpin to increase that limit.

Influence of Shards

Whispers of Ruin trait on Hemalurgic Spikes was designed to be a clearly defined set of conditions and test DCs to represent the influence of the Shards and help the GM to define and trigger those moments.

This doesn't mean the GM cannot initiate the influence on their own, if the story demands it. The GM can also set their own DC for the tests. The rules in this book are meant to help the GM, not constrict them, and, as always, the GM has the final say.

1.3 Hemalurgy Talents

Protégé of Ruin (Key Talent)

Prerequisite: Hemalurgist Patron or other source of knowledge about the art of Hemalurgy

Activation: ★

The art that is unique to Hemalurgy is the knowledge of where to place the spikes.

Gain Hemalurgy Expertise, which allows you to recognize Hemalurgic Spikes and to know their application. Additionally, you gain the goal "Learn Hemalurgy". After you complete it, you gain Hemalurgy skill and 1 rank in it.

Combat Hemalurgy

Prerequisite: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy" goal

Activation: ∞

Kill her with the spike, and drive it into your own body. That is the only way!

You may use Hemalurgy as ▶ after you hit another character with a metal melee weapon you have an expertise in, as long as you spend 2 Focus or ⚔ from that attack. In that case, your metal weapon will take the role of the spike.

Starting from tier 2, you may also use this talent after hitting a character with a ranged weapon you have an expertise in. Starting from tier 3, you may also use this talent after a trap you made triggered and hit a character.

Ruinous Spike

Prerequisite: Combat Hemalurgy or Forbidden Medicine talent

Activation: ∞

YOU SHOULD KILL THEM.

After you successfully pass the Hemalurgy test, the target suffers 1d4 spirit damage. The size of dice increases with your ranks in Hemalurgy; at 2 ranks, roll 1d6 (instead of 1d4), and so on.

If you use a previously created Hemalurgic Spike as a weapon, it deals an additional 1d4 spirit damage on hit. The size of dice increases with your ranks in Hemalurgy. This dice cannot be used to graze the enemy.

Steel Linchpin

Prerequisite: Lore 4+; Ruinous Spike talent

Activation: ∞

Another spike! That is the secret!

You may use steel spikes to steal the target's capacity for the number of Hemalurgic Spikes a person can use at the same time before succumbing to Ruin's influence.

A person can usually use 3 Hemalurgic Spikes before the Shard takes control of them. You may use the Linchpin Spike to increase that limit.

The Linchpin counts as a Spike toward that limit. A person can have only one Linchpin. If at any point you lose the Linchpin while having 4 or more other Spikes, your character is lost to Ruin.

Additionally, for as long as the Linchpin Spike is implanted, all Spikes can never reduce the user's Spiritual Defense by more than -2.

Forbidden Medicine

Prerequisite: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy" goal

Activation: ∞

For all that it disgusts me, I cannot help but be impressed by Hemalurgy as an art.

When making a Medicine test, you may add your Hemalurgy ranks on top of other modifiers. That includes, but is not limited to, Medicine tests to implant and remove Hemalurgic Spikes.

Stacking Potency

Prerequisite: Forbidden Medicine talent

Activation: ∞

Roughly five percent Invested. Fully Investing one spike takes between twenty and thirty people.

You may use a previously created Hemalurgic Spike as a spike while testing Hemalurgy to increase its potency. If you do, you may only choose to steal the same characteristic as was previously stolen by the spike.

The new potency is 1 higher than the previous one, or 1 higher than whatever the spike would have after the new Hemalurgy test, whichever is higher. At any point the potency of a newly created Hemalurgic Spike cannot exceed a number of your ranks in Hemalurgy or the spike's capacity.

You cannot use this talent if either the target or your Spike don't have at least 1 of the characteristic you wish to steal (eg. if you have some trace amounts stolen with Vestigial Powers).

Deathless Spike

Prerequisite: Medicine 4+; Forbidden Medicine talent

Activation: ∞

The process involves a very thin spike, my lord, and, oddly, the right mindset.

You don't need to wait for the donor's death to collect the Hemalurgic Spike after the successful Hemalurgy test. Once the Spike is removed from the donor's body, they lose the characteristic stolen by the Spike in the amount of the Spike's potency.

Vestigial Powers

Prerequisite: Lore 4+; Stacking Potency talent

Activation: ∞

They don't need that extra if the powers didn't manifest in them. We simply slice it off and use it in a spike.

You may choose to steal a skill your target doesn't have developed (eg. a specific Allomantic power). If you do, after collecting the created Spike, it gains a single Charge of that skill instead of Blessing trait.

You may continue using the Spike in your Hemalurgy tests to gather more Charges for the selected skill. You may target each character only once.

While the Spike is implanted in your body, you may spend 1 Charge to make a single test of the stolen skill. Alternatively, you may spend 5 Charges to give the Spike Blessing [stolen skill +1], allowing it to grant a permanent bonus.

You may continue to increase permanent Blessing bonus up to the Spike's capacity or the number of your Hemalurgy ranks, whatever is smaller.

Sinister Mastery

Prerequisite: Crafting 4+; Ruinous Spike talent

Activation: ∞

How could such a change be effected by a single spike? This is a level of Hemalurgy beyond my understanding.

You may use Spiritual metals as Hemalurgic Spikes as if you were tier 4 character. Additionally, you may use Hemalurgy with intention to steal unique characteristics, not specified in the list of properties of each Hemalurgic metals. Work with your GM to determine if the characteristic can be stolen and which metal should be used as a spike to achieve this. Examples may include:

- maximum Health or Focus,
- innate Deflect Value,
- non-Invested skills,
- non-Scadrial Invested skills,
- unique Features and Actions,
- talents, or other special abilities,
- etc.

Hemalurgy Talent Tree

In line with Ruin's own appointed purpose, Hemalurgy gives great gifts - but at a high cost.



★ Protégé of Ruin (Key)

Requires: Patron or other source of Hemalurgic knowledge.

Gain Hemalurgy Expertise and start "Learn Hemalurgy" goal. After you complete it, you will gain Hemalurgy skill.

∞ Combat Hemalurgy

Requires: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy"

You may spend  to use Hemalurgy after hitting with a weapon.

∞ Ruinous Spike

Successful Hemalurgy tests and attacks with Hemalurgic Spikes deal an additional 1d4* spirit damage.

∞ Steel Linchpin

Requires: Lore 4+

Increase a capacity to use more Hemalurgic Spikes.

∞ Sinister Mastery

Requires: Crafting 4+

You may use more advanced spikes. You may use Hemalurgy to steal unique features and abilities.

∞ Forbidden Medicine

Requires: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy"

You may add your ranks in Hemalurgy to Medicine tests you make.

∞ Stacking Potency

You may use the same spike multiple times to increase its potency.

∞ Vestigial Powers

Requires: Lore 4+

You may steal a trace amounts of a skill your target has not developed.

∞ Deathless Spike

Requires: Medicine 4+

Your target doesn't need to die in order to create a Hemalurgic Spike.

1.4 Hemalurgic Constructs

Using the forbidden art, a skillful Hemalurgist may not only steal powers from their victims, but also use the spikes to create twisted monstrosities. Examples might include koloss warriors or hemalurgic chimeras. The process requires much time and skill, but a player may work with the GM to determine how to approach it.

Time-consuming Process

It takes a lot of time and effort to properly study this branch of Hemalurgy, prepare all required spikes, spike the victim and wait for the effect to fully take place. This is not something that can be quickly completed in a midst of Combat and instead should be treated as a goal the PC pursues.

Limited to a Reward

An ability to create a limitless army of hemalurgic monsters would quickly spiral out of control. To limit it, the creation of such constructs can be only achieved as a reward. Refer to "Reward Categories - Companions" (*Mistborn Handbook*, page 286.) for more details.

Before Starting...

At the moment a PC starts a goal to create a Hemalurgic Construct, they must define the desired result they are trying to achieve. They can choose one of the better-known monstrosities, or use their creativity to design something on their own.

When designing a new Construct, the player may wish to apply some of the below effects or to define some other, more unique powers they wish to bestow upon their creation:

- Increased Strength, Speed, or other attributes
- Increased Deflect, Focus or Investiture
- Access to Invested Arts
- Actions or Features of a wild animal
- Special abilities

Depending on the desired results, the PC will need to gather required Hemalurgic Spikes to complete their creation. Work with your GM to clearly define the requirements. Note that for more complex Constructs, you might need unique metals, like trellium or atium.

Known Constructs

Here is the list of official Hemalurgic Constructs presented in Cosmere® RPG sources. You can pick one of them as a final result of your creation or use them as an inspiration for more personalized experiments:

- **Hemalurgic Beast**
Tier 1 Boss
see *Mistborn Legacy*, page 218.
- **Koloss Neophyte**
Tier 2 Rival
see *Mistborn World Guide*, page 244.
- **Hemalurgic Chimera**
Tier 3 Minion
see *Mistborn World Guide*, page 234.

Stats' Range

When creating your own Hemalurgic Construct, make sure to work with your GM to confirm the final design is well-balanced. Compare with other Cosmere® RPG adversaries for reference or follow the guidelines below:

- **Tier 1 Minion**
Max attribute: 3
Total attributes: 6-7
Max skill rank: 3
Total skill ranks: 7-8
Health: 10-13
- **Tier 1 Rival / Tier 2 Minion**
Max attribute: 4 (tier 1) - 5 (tier 2)
Total attributes: 14-15
Max skill rank: 3
Total skill ranks: 12-15
Health: 20-25
- **Tier 2 Rival / Tier 3 Minion**
Max attribute: 6
Total attributes: 17-20
Max skill rank: 4
Total skill ranks: 15-20
Health: 50-60

Construct's Progression

As your PC advances to a higher tier, your Construct may advance as well as a reward. For example, your **Koloss Neophyte** may grow to become **Koloss Veteran**.

1.5 Hemalurgy on Other Worlds

Though never confirmed, it is theorized that Hemalurgy can steal powers originating from beyond the world of Scadrial. Work with your GM to confirm if that can happen in your games.

1.5.1 Stealing Roshar Surges

Ars Arcanum assigns the following gemstone to the corresponding Herald. It is possible you could use the shards of those gemstones as spikes to Hemalurgically steal the Surges related to them.

Gemstone	Herald	Surge 1	Surge 2
Sapphire	Jezrien	Gravitation	Adhesion
Smokestone	Nale	Division	Gravitation
Ruby	Chanarach	Abrasion	Division
Diamond	Vedel	Progression	Abrasion
Emerald	Pralla	Illumination	Progression
Garnet	Shalash	Transformation	Illumination
Zircon	Battar	Transportation	Transformation
Amethyst	Kalak	Cohesion	Transportation
Topaz	Talanel	Tension	Cohesion
Heliodor	Ishar	Adhesion	Tension

1.6 Hemalurgist's Weaponry

While any metal weapon can be used to create a Hemalurgic Spike, a Hemalurgist may prefer to select tools designed for this purpose.

1.6.1 Weapons

Skill	Type	Damage	Range	Traits	Expert Traits
Light Weaponry	Needle	0-1 keen	Melee	Discreet, Unique: Subtle	Unique: Precise
Light Weaponry	Small Spike	1d4 keen	Melee	Quickdraw	Offhand
Light Weaponry	Needle Blower	0-1 keen	Ranged [30/120]	Quickdraw	Unique: Quiet
Heavy Weaponry	Big Spike	1d6 keen	Melee	Pierce	Offhand
Heavy Weaponry	Hammer and Nail	1d8 keen	Melee	Two-Handed, Deadly	Unique: Brutal
Heavy Weaponry	Spike Thrower	1d6 keen	Ranged [150/600]	Loaded[1], Two-Handed	Unique: Restraining

1.6.2 Weapon Traits

Some of the weapons presented in this chapter have new traits. You can find their definitions listed below:

Brutal

Attacks made with this weapon gain an advantage to their damage dice.

Precise

Attacks made with this weapon gain an advantage to determine if the attack hits the target.

Quiet

Attacks made with this weapon do not alert the enemies about your position.

Restraining

Spend  from the attack with this weapon to make the target you hit Restrained.

Subtle

While attacking with this weapon you may choose not to add your skill bonus to the damage dealt.

1.7 Document History

This book might be expanded and improved based on players' feedback. The table below shows what was changed. You can compare it with the version you own to quickly spot the differences.

Date	Author	What is new?
2026.09.23	Pether.pg	- Added rules for creating Hemalurgic Constructs. - Added section to clarify how this ruleset modifies Hemalurgy rules defined in <i>Mistborn Handbook</i> (or, to be precise, how it does not). - Changed Hemalurgy skill activation to ►►► to align with Implant Spike action defined in <i>Mistborn Handbook</i> and to avoid confusion. Updated Combat Hemalurgy talent to allow skill activation as ►. - Clarified Whispers of Ruin failure effect. Changed the effect to give the player choice of creating a new PC or continuing as the same one. - Rebalanced Whispers of Ruin to avoid complex math and not to discourage players from investing in Hemalurgy skill development. - Decreased the Spikes' potency based on the target's value by 1 to align with official lore of Hemalurgy being an end-negative power. - Added Forbidden Medicine talent to help with Medicine tests, including implanting and removing Hemalurgic Spikes. - Added Sinister Mastery talent to allow for more creative Hemalurgy plays and Spikes' applications. - Deathless Spike talent now requires Medicine 4+. - Rebalanced Ruinous Spike talent to deal 1d4 spirit damage instead of 2d4. - Ruinous Spike talent now also deals damage when the spike is used as a weapon. - Steel Linchpin talent now reduces Spiritual Defense penalty applied by implanted Hemalurgic Spikes. - Updted Vestigial Powers talent to make it more consistent with other Cosmere® RPG rules. - Reorganized Hemalurgy Talent Tree and talents' requirements to include new talents. - Added hypothesized (unconfirmed by official lore) properties of a Trellium spike. - Added hypothesized (unconfirmed by official lore) spikes required to steal Roshar surges. - Updated Hemalurgy Talent Tree color scheme to align with <i>Mistborn Handbook</i>.
2026.09.12	Pether.pg	Initial version